

Global CO₂ Emissions

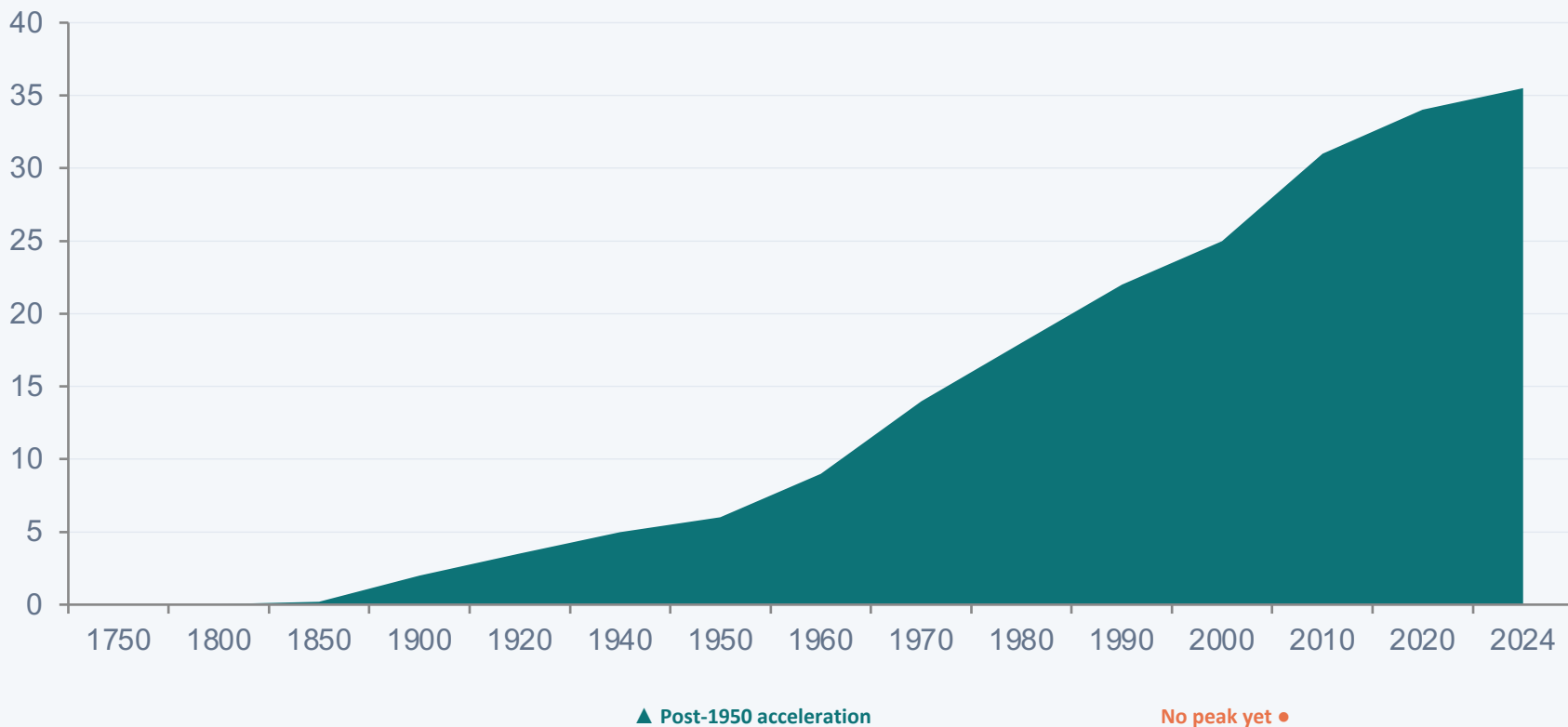
Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry | 1750–2024

For policy analysts, climate negotiators & sustainability researchers

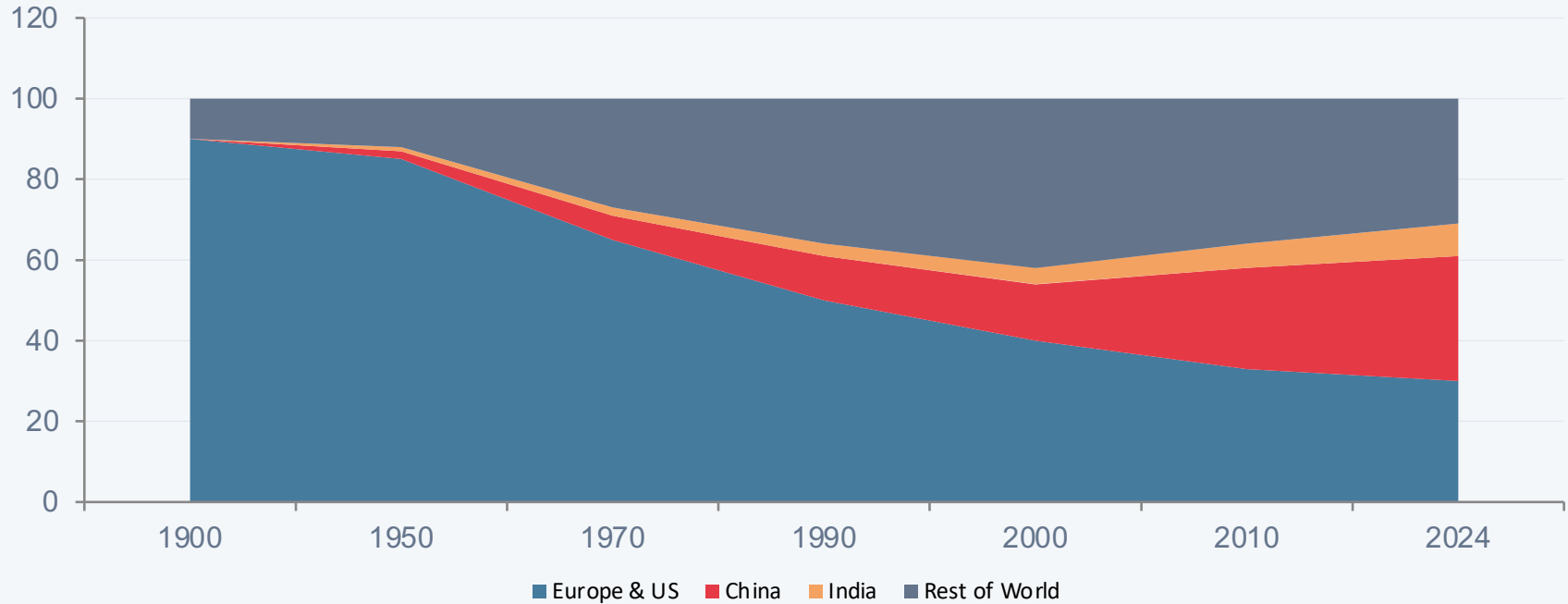
Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



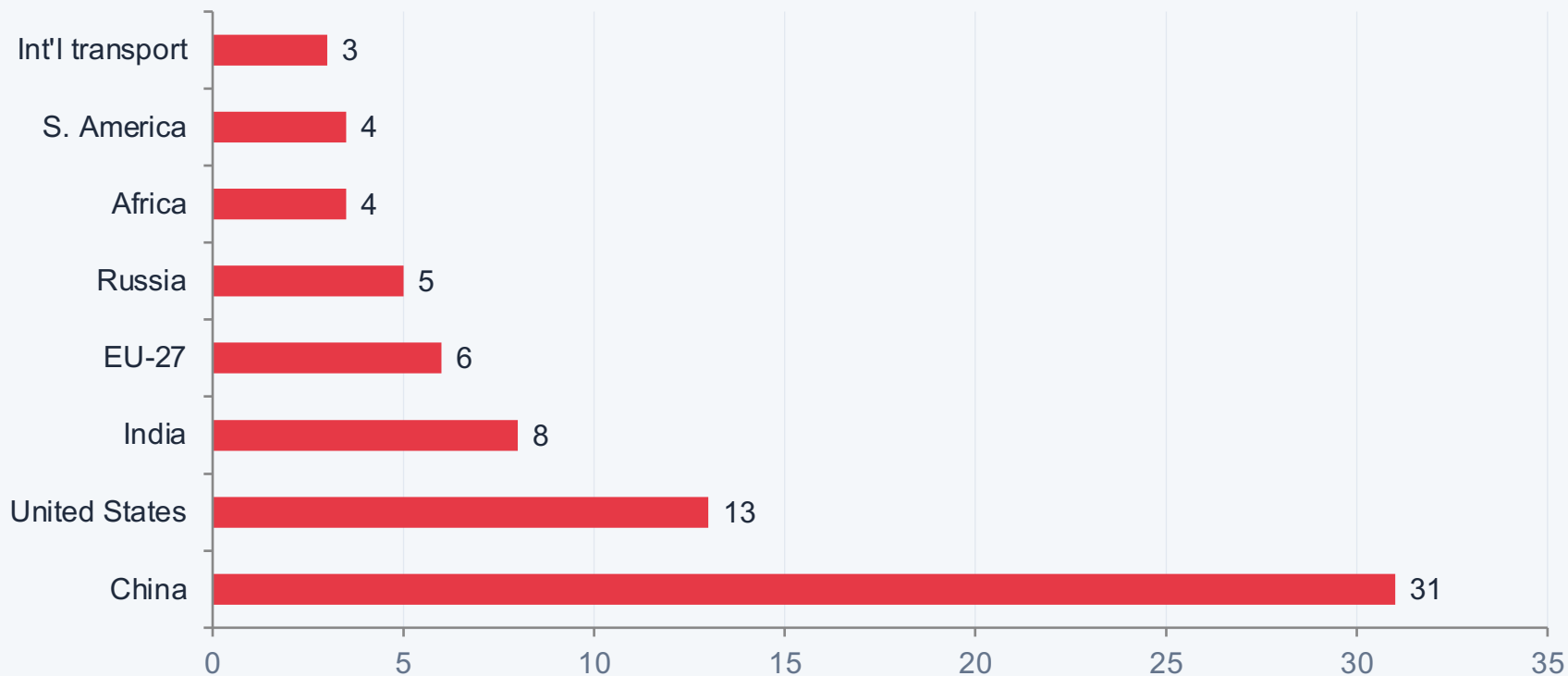
Source: Global Carbon Budget 2025

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Third Today



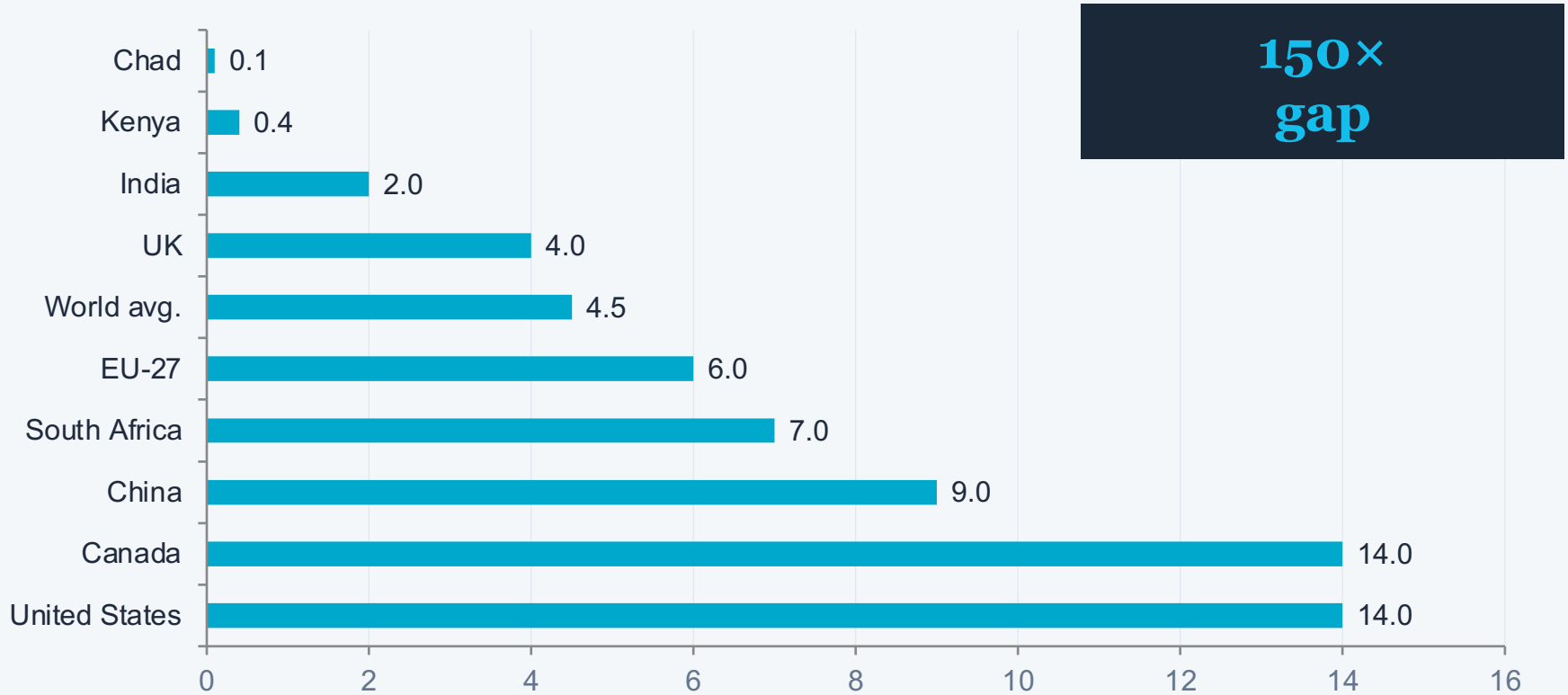
Share of global CO₂ emissions (%)

China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂

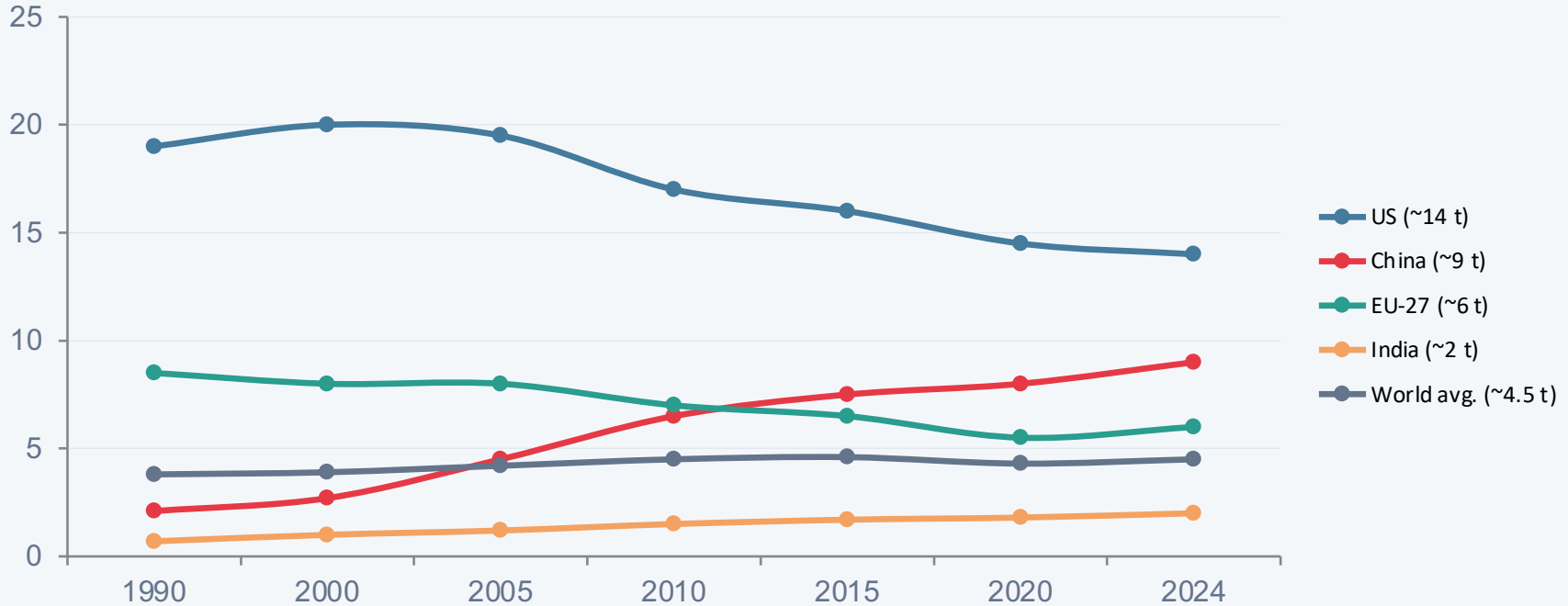


Africa and South America each account for only 3–4% — comparable to international aviation & shipping.

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Canada



Per Capita Emissions: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



China's per capita emissions remain below the US despite being the largest total emitter.

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Than Germany or the US



Key driver:

Electricity source mix

France, UK, Portugal:

High nuclear + renewables

Germany, Netherlands, US:

Higher fossil fuel reliance

Similar prosperity levels — very different emissions outcomes.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- Global emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and have not yet peaked, despite slowing growth.
- China is the largest annual emitter (~31%) but per capita remains below the US (~9 t vs. ~14 t).
- Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US (>90% in 1900, <33% today).
- A 150× per capita gap persists between the poorest nations (~0.1 t) and the richest (~14 t).
- Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions — France and the UK demonstrate this.